Preprocessing Guide

Choose preprocessing steps based on the variable type, rather than applying every step to every variable.

Variable / issue	What should I do?	Tool or rule
Missing values	Check the variables the model uses; do not treat observed zeros as missing.	`drop_na()` or a justified missing-value strategy.
Continuous predictor: `PreviousSpend`	If skewed, test whether log helps.	`step_log(PreviousSpend, offset = 1)`
Binary predictor: `Treatment`	Keep 0/1; 0 = no email is the reference.	Do not log or add a second indicator.
Categorical predictor: `Education`	Set the factor baseline; create k-1 indicators.	`fct_relevel()` then `step_dummy()`
Continuous outcome: `CampaignSpend`	If skewed, compare raw and logged models.	`step_log(CampaignSpend, offset = 1)`; reverse with `exp(.pred) - 1`.
Optional numeric-predictor tools	Standardize scales / remove highly correlated inputs / create bins.	`step_normalize()` / `step_corr()` / `step_discretize()`.